



BUILT WITH SCIENCE™

BWS

WORKOUT

ABS

TABLE OF CONTENTS

THE ABS WORKOUT	3
EXERCISE 1: REVERSE CRUNCHES	4
EXERCISE 2 (OPTION A): HIGH TO LOW CABLE WOODCHOPPERS	5
EXERCISE 2 (OPTION B): BICYCLE KICKS	6
SHORTCUT YOUR TRANSFORMATION!	7
EXERCISE 3 (OPTION A): WEIGHTED STABILITY BALL CRUNCHES	8
EXERCISE 3 (OPTION B): WEIGHTED CABLE CRUNCHES	9
EXERCISE 4: SERRATUS JABS	10
ADDITIONAL COMMENTS	11
DISCLAIMER	12



THE ABS WORKOUT

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS	REST (M)
Reverse Crunches (Bodyweight) PROGRESS TO Reverse Crunches (Weighted)	2-3	15-20 10-15	1
High To Low Cable Woodchoppers OR Bicycle Kicks	2-3	10-15 To fatigue	1
Weighted Stability Ball Crunch OR Weighted Cable Crunch	2-3	10-15	1
Serratus Jabs	2-3 each side	10-15	30s per side

Perform this abs workout 1-3 times per week, either after your main weightlifting workouts or on rest days.

EXERCISE 1: REVERSE CRUNCHES

STEP 1 (SETUP)

Lay flat on a bench and raise your legs and bend to roughly 90 degrees. Get into posterior pelvic tilt by squeezing your glutes and contracting your abs. As a result, your back will be flattened entirely onto the bench or ground. Maintain this posterior pelvic tilt throughout the movement.

STEP 2 (CURL)

Next, lift your pelvis off the bench and curl your hips up towards your belly button. As you do so, think about contracting your lower abs. This should be done in a controlled manner with your legs kept slightly bent.

STEP 3 (DESCENT)

Slowly descend in a controlled manner until your legs are just past 90 degrees of bend, and then repeat for another rep. Ensure that your lower back remains flat on the bench throughout, and avoid using momentum.

STEP 4 (PROGRESSION)

Progress the movement overtime by adding a weight between your legs and/or performing your reps on a decline bench.



EXERCISE 2 (OPTION A): HIGH TO LOW CABLE WOODCHOPPERS

STEP 1 (SETUP)

Use a standard handle attachment and move the cable to the highest pulley position. With your side to the cable, grab the handle with both hands and take a step away from it. You should be approximately arm's length away from the pulley and your feet positioned a little wider than shoulder-width apart and knees slightly bent.

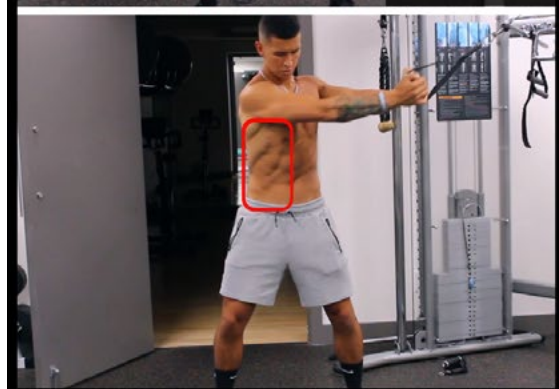
STEP 2 (TWIST)

Pull the handle down and across your body to your opposite front knee by rotating your torso. You should be actively using your abdominals and obliques to move the weight, as opposed to simply using your arms – your arms are just there to hold the weight but it's your torso that rotates to do the moving. Your arms should remain straight as you twist, and your hips should remain facing forward.

STEP 3 (RETURN)

Return to the neutral position in a slow and controlled manner and then repeat for more reps. Add more weight to progress the movement.

You want to feel your obliques working during each rep. For example, when twisting down to the right, you should feel your right oblique working as you rotate your torso to move the weight.



EXERCISE 2 (OPTION B): BICYCLE KICKS

STEP 1 (SETUP)

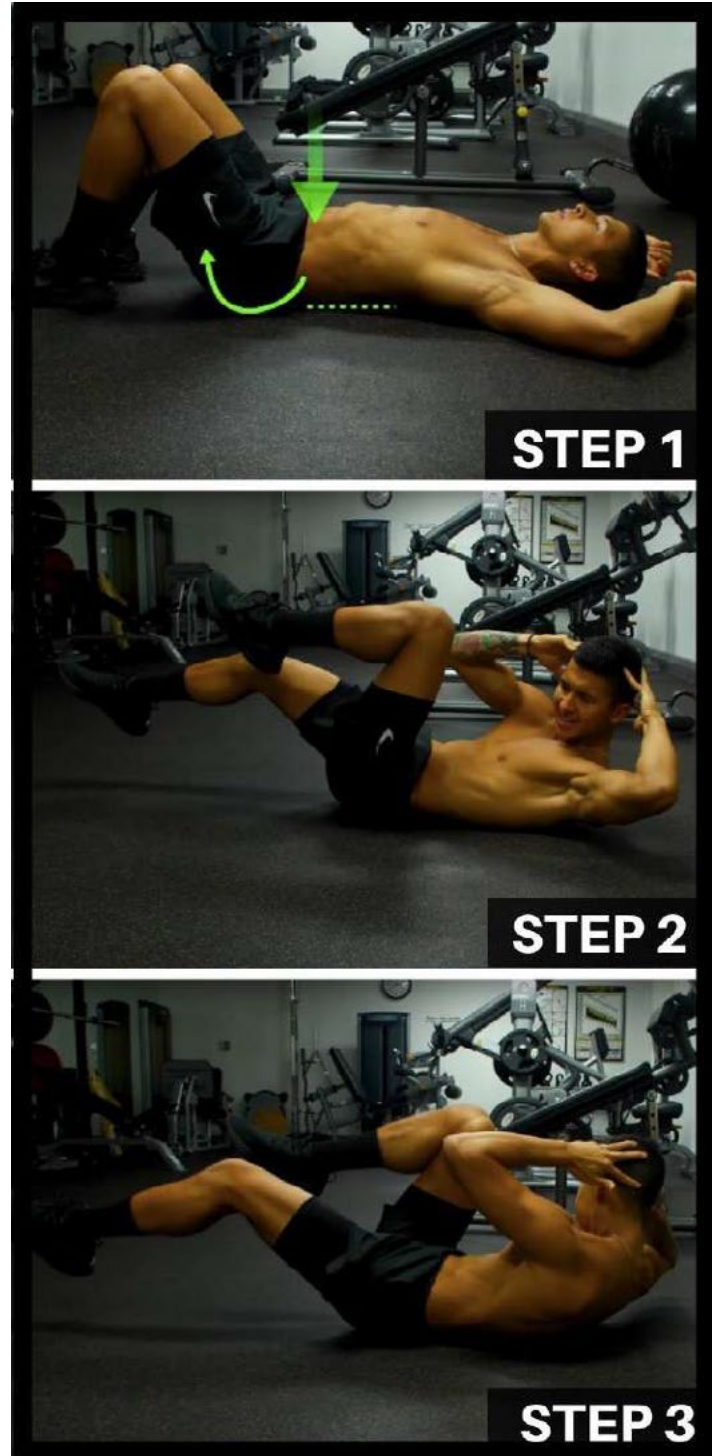
Lie on your back and move into posterior pelvic tilt by squeezing your glutes and drawing your belly button in towards your stomach. Your lower back should flatten on the ground as a result of this.

STEP 2 (TWIST)

Twist to one side extending your right leg straight out while twisting your torso so that your right underarm rotates towards your left knee.

STEP 3 (TWIST)

Reverse the step 2 motion and repeat on the other side. Simply think about trying to touch your opposite shoulder to your opposite knee. Your shoulder blades should be completely off the floor and your lower back should be flat against the ground throughout the movement.



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EXERCISE 3 (OPTION A): WEIGHTED STABILITY BALL CRUNCHES

STEP 1 (SETUP)

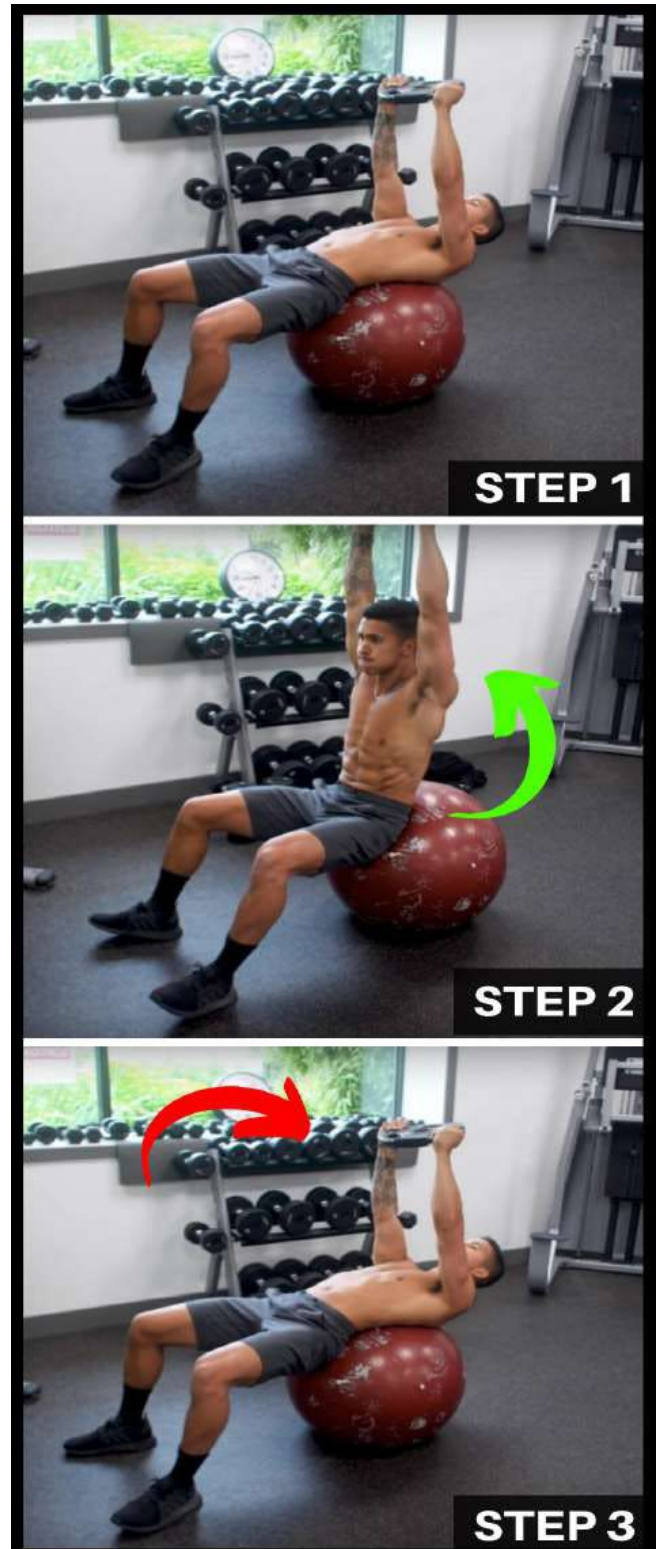
Lay on a stability ball with your legs bent to roughly 90 degrees. If you have the abdominal strength to do so apply additional resistance to the movement by holding a weight overhead. Pre-contraction your abs by drawing your belly button in towards your stomach.

STEP 2 (CRUNCH)

Crunch your body up by bringing your ribs towards your pelvis. Your arms should move straight overhead as you do so. You should feel a strong contraction in your upper abdominal region.

STEP 3 (DESCENT)

Slowly descend in a controlled manner until your return to the starting position. Your hips should remain in the same position during the ascent and descent of each rep.



EXERCISE 3 (OPTION B): WEIGHTED CABLE CRUNCHES

STEP 1 (SETUP)

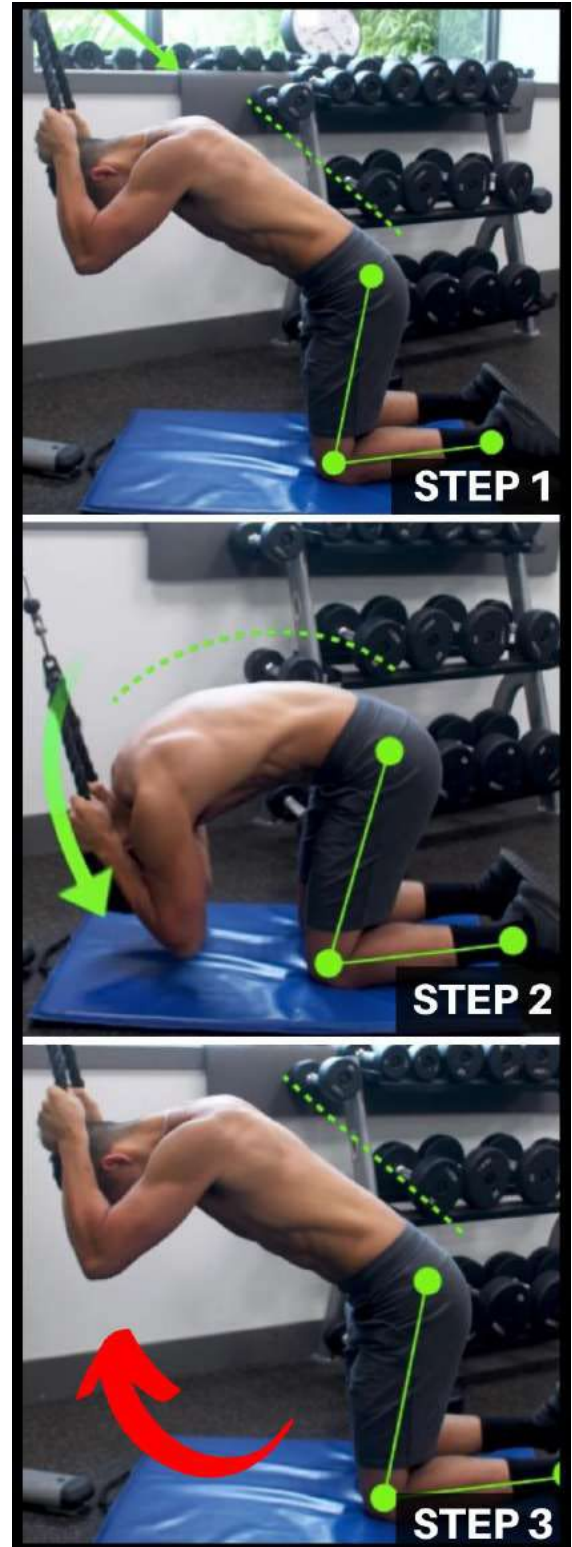
Kneel below a high pulley that contains either the rope attachment or the seated row attachment, whichever is more comfortable for you. Grasp the attachment and lower it until your hands are placed next to your face. The handle should be directly behind your neck. Position yourself such that you're not too close to the pulley yet not too far – find the sweet spot that allows you to have the best range of motion and activation of your abs when you crunch.

STEP 2 (CRUNCH)

While on your knees, flex your torso down by contracting your upper abs while exhaling. Think about trying to bring the elbows down towards the middle of your thighs, and you should be flexing at the spine as you do so.

STEP 3 (RETURN)

Hold for a second at the bottom position while contracting your abs before returning to the top position and repeating for another rep. Avoid using excessive momentum, instead each rep should be controlled with a focus on properly engaging the upper abs.



EXERCISE 4: SERRATUS JABS

STEP 1 (SETUP):

Set up the resistance by either using a band looped around a fixture or a cable system. Make sure to set it up at a low angle such that your arm can travel upwards as you punch to promote upward rotation of the scapula. Start with your elbow positioned by your side and your body and hips facing forward.

STEP 2 (JAB)

Simply perform an upward punching motion and reach as far as you can at the end position in order to protract that scapula and fully activate the serratus anterior. Think of it as punching forward, and then “reaching” out as far as you can after your punch.

STEP 3 (RETURN)

Return back to the starting position before proceeding to perform another rep.



ADDITIONAL COMMENTS

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